Immediately, the patient should be administered a readily available carbohydrate source like glucose, candy, syrup, honey or fruit juices. Therefore diabetics should always be advised to carry sugar candy to control the condition causing symptoms when they are still mild.

Diabetic acidosis and Coma: Diabetic ketoacidosis is a case of severe insulin deficiency characterized by hyperglycaemia, elevated glucagon levels, acidosis and elevated blood ketones. This is caused due to the following reasons:

- The patient ingests extra /additional food which is more than that is controlled by the insulin dose.
- The patient omitted taking the insulin dose.
- The patient forgot to take the correct insulin dose.
- Injury
- Trauma
- Surgery

The symptoms are weakness, headache, pain, nausea, vomiting, flushed, dry and hot skin and dry mouth with increased thirst. One key symptom is acetone odour in the breath accompanied with painful and rapid breathing and dizziness. Clinical symptoms of shock are exhibited with unconsciousness followed by death unless prompt measures are taken.

9.8.2. Chronic complications

Retinopathy: Diabetic retinopathy also known as diabetic eye disease is caused due to damage occurring to the retina of the eye as a result of diabetes. It can eventually lead to blindness. Early detection, timely treatment and appropriate follow-up care of diabetic eye disease can protect against vision loss.

Nephropathy: Diabetic nephropathy is the damage caused to the kidneys or development of kidney disease due to diabetes. It involves functional or structural damage to the nephrons and associated organ systems. This results in malfunctioning of the kidneys eventually leading to kidney failure.

Neuropathy: Patients with diabetes are especially vulnerable to the development of nerve damage and diminished transmission of nerve impulses which affect muscle function and sensory perception in vein-less parts of the body.

Diabetic Cardiomyopathy: It is a disease that damages the structure and function of the heart due to diabetes. This disease can lead to heart failure and arrhythmias.



Eight symptoms of Diabetes not to be ignored to prevent complications

1. Tingling sensation in feet
2. Occurrence of sores and blisters
3. Poor wound healing
4. Skin problems
5. Swelling in the feet
6. Digestive problems
7. Blurry vision
8. Chest pain



Stress is a well known offender in causing blood glucose levels to rise, particularly in patients with type 2 diabetes. Yoga, progressive relaxation, massage therapy, exercise and meditation are just a few ways to distress. Talk therapy, either one-to-one with a counselor or in a support group, can also be extremely helpful.

UNIT 9_new.indd 155 25-02-2019 15:37:16